PRACTICE PACK

Festivals Around the World

Comparing, then and now, and the words you need. Work at your own pace.

HOW TO USE THIS PACK

- Five parts, about 20 minutes each. Do one part, rest, do another. Do not do it all in one evening.
- Work alone, with a pencil. A wrong answer is useful: it shows us what to practise.
- The answers and the explanations in Spanish are on the last two pages. Try everything first, then check.
- No marks. Bring the pack to class and we look at it together.

THE FACT FILE: USE IT FOR PARTS 1 AND 2

Festival (place)	Started	When	Lasts	People (about)
The Fallas (Valencia, Spain)	many years ago	15-19 March	5 days	no figure
La Tomatina (Buñol, Spain)	1945	last Wednesday of August	1 hour	20,000
Glastonbury (Pilton, Somerset, England)	1970	usually late June	5 days	200,000
Notting Hill Carnival (London, England)	1966	August bank holiday weekend	3 days	up to 2 million (an estimate)
Vivid Sydney (Sydney, Australia)	2009	May and June	23 nights	3.28 million (in 2023)
Cape Town International Jazz Festival (South Africa)	2000	usually March	2 days	34,000 (in 2013)

Figures are approximate. Sources: the festivals' own information, Wikipedia and news reports, checked in October 2026.

DID YOU KNOW?

- About 400 neighbourhood groups build monuments for the Fallas in Valencia. The monuments burn on the night of 19 March.
- At La Tomatina, the crowd throws about 120 tonnes of tomatoes in one hour.
- The Lamu Cultural Festival, on an island in Kenya, began in 2001. People call it the island's biggest and oldest festival, and a donkey race is one of its highlights.

PART 1 Bigger, older, the most famous

about 25 min

EXERCISE A · COMPLETE THE TABLE

Write the missing forms. The first row is an example.

Adjective	Comparative	Superlative
big	bigger	the biggest
old		
crowded		
new	newer	
good		
loud		
bad	worse	
famous		
cheap		the cheapest

EXERCISE B · CIRCLE THE CORRECT OPTION

Use the fact file on page 1.

1. La Tomatina is a) more old b) older c) oldest than the Notting Hill Carnival.
2. The Cape Town Jazz Festival is a) newest b) more new c) newer than Glastonbury.
3. Vivid Sydney is a) the biggest b) bigger c) the most big festival in the table.
4. La Tomatina is a) shorter b) the most short c) the shortest festival in the table.
5. The Fallas last a) more long b) longer c) the longer than the Notting Hill Carnival.
6. Glastonbury has a) the more b) most c) more visitors than La Tomatina.

EXERCISE C · FIND THE MISTAKE

Each sentence has one mistake. Cross it out and write the sentence correctly.

1. Glastonbury is more bigger than La Tomatina.

2. La Tomatina is older that the Notting Hill Carnival.

3. Vivid Sydney is the biggest festival of the table.

4. Vivid Sydney is the most new festival in the table.

5. La Tomatina is the shorter festival in the table.

EXERCISE D · WRITE YOUR OWN SENTENCES

One sentence each. Use the fact file. Remember: one syllable = -er; a long word = more; always than.

1. The Fallas and the Cape Town Jazz Festival: how long they last.

2. The Notting Hill Carnival and Vivid Sydney: which is older.

3. All six festivals: a sentence with a superlative (the biggest, the oldest, the shortest...).

4. A festivity you know well and La Tomatina: one comparison with *than*.

EXERCISE E · THAN, IN OR OF?

in · of · than

1. Glastonbury lasts longer ..... La Tomatina.
2. In my opinion, March is the best month ..... the year in Valencia.
3. Valencia is the third biggest city ..... Spain.
4. Paella is the most famous dish ..... the Valencian Community.
5. Summer is hotter ..... spring in Valencia.
6. August is the hottest month ..... the year.

PART 2 Then and now

about 25 min

EXERCISE A · PAST OR PRESENT?

Put the verb in brackets in the right tense. Then = simple past. Now = simple present. Look for the clue words (*in 1970*, *today*).

1 · GLASTONBURY, ENGLAND

The first Glastonbury Festival (take place) _____ in September 1970 in Pilton, a village in Somerset. At that time it (be) _____ called the Pilton Festival. Today the festival usually (be) _____ in June, it (last) _____ five days, and about 200,000 people (go) _____ to it.

2 · NOTTING HILL CARNIVAL, LONDON

The Notting Hill Carnival (start) _____ in 1966. People from the British Caribbean community in London (begin) _____ it. Today it (happen) _____ every year on the August bank holiday weekend and it (last) _____ three days. Some people say that up to two million people (come) _____ .

3 · LAMU CULTURAL FESTIVAL, KENYA

The Lamu Cultural Festival (begin) _____ in 2001, on an island in Kenya. Today people (call) _____ it the island's biggest and oldest festival, and the donkey race (be) _____ one of its highlights.

EXERCISE B · PAST FORMS

Write the simple past. Three are regular, but watch the spelling!

begin → _____

build → _____

take → _____

stop → _____

throw → _____

ban → _____

hold → _____

come → _____

EXERCISE C · THEN OR NOW? CIRCLE THE CORRECT VERB

Remember La Tomatina from the reading.

1. In 1945, some children a) start b) started a food fight in Buñol.
2. Today, thousands of people a) threw b) throw tomatoes there every August.
3. In the early 1950s, the government a) bans b) banned the festival.
4. Until 2013, anybody a) could join b) can join the fight.
5. Now the town a) limited b) limits the number to about 20,000.
6. In 2020 and 2021, the festival a) stops b) stopped because of the pandemic.

EXERCISE D · YOUR FESTIVAL, THEN AND NOW

Think of a festival you know well: the Fallas, Sant Joan, a village fiesta, a concert. Write four sentences: two about then (simple past) and two about now (simple present). Use at least one comparative.

1. Then:

2. Then:

3. Now:

4. Now:

EXERCISE E · WRITE THE QUESTION

Write the question for each answer. Use *did* + the base verb for the past (When **did** it **start**?).

1. Answer: In 1966.

2. Answer: About 200,000 people.

3. Answer: On the last Wednesday of August.

4. Answer: Because of the pandemic.

PART 3 The words of a festival

about 20 min

EXERCISE A · MATCH THE WORD TO ITS MEANING

1 parade	a) a large group of people in one place
2 float	b) a place where people put up tents
3 costume	c) a decorated lorry or platform in a parade
4 firework	d) a raised platform where musicians play
5 stage	e) you must buy it before you can go in
6 campsite	f) a line of people and vehicles that moves through the streets
7 crowd	g) a bright explosion of light and noise in the sky
8 ticket	h) special clothes you wear for a festival

Answers: 1___ 2___ 3___ 4___ 5___ 6___ 7___ 8___

EXERCISE B · COMPLETE THE SENTENCES

campsite · costume · crowd · fireworks · float · parade · stage · ticket

1. You need a ..... to go into La Tomatina.
2. At Glastonbury, most people sleep in a tent at a .....
3. The singer walked onto the ..... at ten o'clock.
4. Many women wear a traditional ..... at the Fallas.
5. On the Monday of the Notting Hill Carnival, the big ..... goes through the streets for hours.
6. Each ..... in the parade was covered in flowers.
7. At the end of the Fallas, a huge ..... watches the monuments burn.
8. There are ..... in the sky over Valencia during the Fallas.

EXERCISE C · BRITISH SPELLING: CIRCLE THE BRITISH ONE

1. My a) favourite b) favorite festival is the Fallas.
2. The city a) centre b) center was full of people.
3. We a) organized b) organised a trip to Buñol.
4. The costumes were very a) colourful b) colorful .
5. The festival a) programme b) program has forty events.

PART 4 The small words after verbs

about 15 min

EXERCISE A · WRITE THE MISSING WORD

Use each word from the box. You can use a word more than once.

about · at · for · in · to

1. We arrived _____ Buñol at nine o'clock.
2. Everybody waited _____ the first lorry to arrive.
3. I listened _____ the band for three hours.
4. You have to pay _____ the ticket online.
5. At midnight, we all looked _____ the sky.
6. After the festival, I could not stop thinking _____ next year.
7. Notting Hill is famous _____ its carnival.
8. The monuments burn _____ midnight on 19 March.

EXERCISE B · TRANSLATE INTO ENGLISH

Write the English sentence. Think about the small word.

1. Llegamos a la plaza a las ocho. (Valencia)

2. Escuchamos a la banda durante dos horas.

3. Esperé a mi amiga delante del Mercado Central.

BONUS · SAY IT OUT LOUD (OPTIONAL)

Record a voice note on your phone, 30 seconds. Nobody has to hear it unless you want. Compare your festivity with one festival from the fact file.

Start with: My festivity is older / bigger / less crowded than … · For me, the most exciting festival is … · Years ago, … Now, …

Listen to it once. Do you hear a mistake? Say the sentence again, better.

Respuestas y explicación (en español)

Mira esta página después de hacer los ejercicios. Si algo no sale, no pasa nada: lo repasamos en clase.

PARTE 1 · COMPARATIVOS Y SUPERLATIVOS

A. old: older / the oldest · crowded: more crowded / the most crowded · new: the newest · good: better / the best · loud: louder / the loudest · bad: the worst · famous: more famous / the most famous · cheap: cheaper.

B. 1 b (older) · 2 c (newer) · 3 a (the biggest) · 4 c (the shortest) · 5 b (longer) · 6 c (more).

C. 1 Glastonbury is bigger than La Tomatina. (no se dice more bigger) · 2 La Tomatina is older than the Notting Hill Carnival. · 3 Vivid Sydney is the biggest festival in the table. · 4 Vivid Sydney is the newest festival in the table. · 5 La Tomatina is the shortest festival in the table.

D. Respuesta libre. Ejemplos: The Fallas last longer than the Cape Town Jazz Festival. · The Notting Hill Carnival is older than Vivid Sydney. · La Tomatina is the shortest festival in the table. · My festivity is older than La Tomatina.

E. 1 than · 2 of · 3 in · 4 in · 5 than · 6 of.

REGLAS QUE DEBES RECORDAR

- **Una sílaba: -er / -est.** big, bigger, the biggest. Dos sílabas acabadas en -y también: noisy, noisier, the noisiest.
- **Palabra larga: more / the most.** more crowded, the most famous. **Nunca las dos cosas:** no se dice *more bigger* ni *the most newest*.
- **Than** siempre va con el comparativo: older **than** (no *that*, no *of*).
- **Superlativo: the + -est / the most.** Después, **in** + lugar o lista (in the table, in Spain, in the world) y **of** + tiempo o grupo (of the year, of my life, of all).
- Irregulares: good, better, the best · bad, worse, the worst.

PARTE 2 · PASADO SIMPLE Y PRESENTE

A. 1 took place · was · is · lasts · go. 2 started · began · happens · lasts · come. 3 began · call · is.

B. begin: began · build: built · take: took · stop: stopped · throw: threw · ban: banned · hold: held · come: came. En *stop* y *ban* se duplica la última consonante (stopped, banned).

C. 1 b (started) · 2 b (throw) · 3 b (banned) · 4 a (could join) · 5 b (limits) · 6 b (stopped).

D. Respuesta libre. Antes (then) = pasado simple: *Thirty years ago the Fallas were smaller.* Ahora (now) = presente simple: *Today the monuments are bigger.*

E. 1 When did the Notting Hill Carnival start? · 2 How many people go to Glastonbury? · 3 When is La Tomatina? · 4 Why did La Tomatina stop in 2020 and 2021? En preguntas en pasado, *did* + verbo base: *did it start*, no *did it started*.

EXPLICACIÓN DEL PASADO SIMPLE

- Una acción terminada con una fecha o una palabra de tiempo pasado (in 1970, in 1945, until 2013, last year) va en **pasado simple**. Una situación de ahora (today, now, every year) va en **presente simple**.
- Una costumbre del pasado también es pasado simple: *every year people went to the square*, no *were going*.
- Irregulares: hay que aprenderlos de memoria (began, took, threw, held, came, built).

PARTE 3 · VOCABULARIO

A. 1 f · 2 c · 3 h · 4 g · 5 d · 6 b · 7 a · 8 e.

B. 1 ticket · 2 campsite · 3 stage · 4 costume · 5 parade · 6 float · 7 crowd · 8 fireworks.

C. 1 favourite · 2 centre · 3 organised · 4 colourful · 5 programme. En inglés británico: -our (colour, favourite, behaviour), -re (centre, theatre), -ise (organise, realise). *Programme* es el programa de un evento; *program* es un programa de ordenador.

PARTE 4 · LAS PALABRAS PEQUEÑAS DESPUÉS DEL VERBO

A. 1 in · 2 for · 3 to · 4 for · 5 at · 6 about · 7 for · 8 at.

B. 1 We arrived at the square at eight o'clock. (también vale: in the square, pero at es lo normal para un punto del recorrido) · 2 We listened to the band for two hours. · 3 I waited for my friend in front of the Central Market.

- **arrive in** + ciudad o país (arrive in Buñol, arrive in Kenya); **arrive at** + lugar concreto (arrive at the campsite). Nunca *arrive to*.
- **wait for** (esperar) · **listen to** (escuchar) · **pay for** (pagar algo) · **look at** (mirar) · **think about** (pensar en) · **famous for** (famoso por). En español no ponemos preposición en esperar, escuchar o pagar, y por eso se nos olvida en inglés.

ANTES DE ENTREGAR

- Lee todo el pack una vez en voz alta. Si algo suena mal, probablemente hay un error.
- Guarda este pack: lo usamos en clase para comparar vuestros festivales.